

Name: _____

Date: _____

Australian Curriculum v9.0 Aligned | AC9E6LY04 | Year 6 | Complex Texts, Perspective & Sustained Argument

LEARNING INTENTION

I am learning to analyse complex texts by examining perspective, evaluating evidence and constructing sustained, well-reasoned arguments.

READING STRATEGY

Identify the author's perspective and purpose. Evaluate the quality of evidence. Consider whose voice is missing. Challenge assumptions and construct your own reasoned position.

READ THE PASSAGE — READ IT 3 TIMES!

The **gig economy** refers to a labour market where people work short-term, flexible contracts rather than traditional permanent employment.

Companies like Uber, Deliveroo and Airbnb have built **billion-dollar** businesses by connecting workers directly with customers through digital **platforms**.

Proponents argue that gig work offers **unprecedented** flexibility — workers choose their hours and locations, making it ideal for students, parents and those with **disabilities**.

Critics, however, point out that gig workers are typically classified as **independent contractors**, meaning they receive no sick leave, superannuation, holiday pay or job **security**.

In Australia, the Fair Work Commission has begun **examining** whether gig workers deserve the same **protections** as employees.

Some economists argue the gig economy represents a fundamental **restructuring** of work — others call it the return of **precarious** labour conditions that workers fought to eliminate a century ago.

Young Australians entering the workforce today are more likely to experience **portfolio careers** — multiple income streams — than a job for life.

The question is whether this represents freedom or **insecurity** — and for whom.

VOCABULARY HELPER

gig economy = a labour market based on short-term contracts and freelance work

independent contractors = self-employed workers who are not classified as employees

precarious = uncertain and potentially dangerous

portfolio careers = having multiple jobs or income sources simultaneously

superannuation = retirement savings contributions made by employers

WARM UP — BEFORE YOU READ

Would you prefer a flexible gig job or a stable permanent job? Give a reason for your choice:

A — COMPREHENSION

1. What is the gig economy?

2. Name 2 advantages of gig work:

3. What protections do gig workers miss out on?

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Answer Guide (For Parent / Teacher Use)

Warm Up: Accept personal preference with reason.

A1. A labour market based on short-term, flexible contracts. **A2.** Flexible hours/locations, ideal for students and parents — any 2. **A3.** Sick leave, superannuation, holiday pay, job security. **A4.** Having multiple income streams or jobs simultaneously.

B1. 'And for whom' questions who really benefits — suggests flexibility may benefit companies more than workers. **B2.** Fact: Uber/Deliveroo/Airbnb are billion-dollar businesses. Opinion: 'unprecedented flexibility' — this is the proponents' characterisation, not a neutral fact.

C: Precarious = uncertain and risky — frames gig work as inherently vulnerable. Language framing: 'unprecedented flexibility' positions gig work positively; 'precarious labour' frames it negatively — same reality, opposite perspectives.

High Five! You are a Super Reader! ✓
Colour a star each time you read the passage aloud:



EXTENSION ACTIVITY

Write an editorial for a youth magazine: 'The future of work: Why young Australians need to prepare for a gig economy.' Include 3 arguments and practical advice.

PARENT TIP

Discuss jobs in your family. Ask: 'What would it mean to have no sick leave or holiday pay? Could our family manage on gig work alone?'

TEACHER TIP

Connect to Economics and Civics. Students research the rights of a gig worker vs a permanent employee. Create a comparison table and write a policy recommendation.

STUDENT REFLECTION

- ☐ I can identify how language frames an argument
- ☐ I can distinguish between fact and opinion in a complex text
- ☐ I can write a balanced argument that considers multiple stakeholders